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Insights from 2026 DB Software Bus Tour

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We came away from our two-and-a-half-day investor bus trip in the San Francisco Bay Area with a better appreciation for how companies are positioning themselves to benefit from the rapid increase in token usage, as well as the ancillary opportunities it creates, particularly in Security. In this report, we outline key takeaways and themes from visits with a dozen public and private companies, along with several meetings with industry participants, including VCs, CISOs and consultants. We provide company-specific highlights from Adobe, Autodesk, CrowdStrike, Intuit, Netskope, Okta, Palo Alto Networks, Rubrik, Salesforce, Snowflake, Vercel and Zscaler.

At the highest level, conversations focused on whether AI is changing demand patterns and how vendors can participate in the continued growth in token usage. We believe those closest to the token stream are seeing the greatest incremental benefit today and remain well positioned over the next several years. This is most evident within Infrastructure, while Security should also benefit as faster model development and greater token usage expand data flows, identities and attack surfaces. Application vendors, meanwhile, are adapting their strategies, including through more headless architectures, to participate more directly in AI-driven workflows. Unsurprisingly these dynamics are already reflected to varying degrees in company valuations, with Snowflake, CrowdStrike and Palo Alto Networks among the more apparent beneficiaries. Nonetheless, we picked up several nuances that should be of interest to investors.

From a **Security perspective**, the overarching focus remained on translating a more constructive cyber-demand environment into tangible new business. Multiple vendors discussed increased infrastructure-modernization activity and associated legacy displacements in recent months as customers become more cognizant of the risks inherent in outdated tooling. In particular, endpoint, hardware firewall, and data resilience appear to be the primary beneficiaries of this trend. That said, vendors, with the notable exception of CRWD, struck a more measured tone on the timing of demand conversion, with several pointing to 2027 as customers secure more robust security budgets. To this point, customers are increasingly carving out a dedicated AI budget for 2027, of which security represents ~3-5% and is incremental to the core cyber budget. All vendors also articulated their right to win in the burgeoning AI security market. While still nascent, we suspect customers will require complementary controls across the network, endpoint, identity, and cloud to provide comprehensive protection, and we continue to view PANW and CRWD as best positioned to lead this market. Ultimately, coming away from our bus tour we reiterate our view that the largest cyber platforms are built for this moment as customers look to build around a

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handful of strategic partners to improve security outcomes against an increasingly challenging threat environment.

As for **Infrastructure software**, it generally remains an AI beneficiary due to the speed at which coding agents are letting companies move the volume of data being computed, stored, observed, etc., and even more so in the case of companies such as Snowflake when they are able to embed themselves directly into the token stream. Cloud migrations have been an enduring driver as are data lifecycle investments, both of which can be seen as precursors or coincident indications in preparation for deploying additional AI functionality into production.

Our conversations with management teams from **Applications vendors**, suggests reinvention for the age of AI remains in progress. Companies are working to capitalize on unique stores of data and context built over many years of operations that they believe are difficult for any potential disruptor to replicate. They are also working to integrate with newer surfaces and drive incremental monetization opportunities, such as through headless architecture. That said, it remains early days with many of these initiatives, and they will take time to play out. From an investor perspective, our conversations indicate a level of skepticism given how others in the software stack are seeing a near-term benefit from the acceleration in token usage while apps vendors are citing more of a multi-year timeline. The deflationary impact of AI was also topical as vendors with more down-market exposure are already having to introduce lower-priced and free offerings in order to drive customer adoption (shifting the balance towards Q from P). The question then is how AI's deflationary impact may impact more enterprise-oriented software vendors, particularly with early headless offerings seemingly requiring premium priced SKUs.

Our conversations with other **industry constituents** throughout the trip cited several recurring themes: (1) It remains very early innings in terms of AI adoption for the non-tech large enterprise; (2) organizations are struggling to see ROI outside of coding and customer-service use cases, which could have an impact on AI budgeting into next year; (3) the context layer is becoming increasingly strategic; (4) pricing strategies will be very important and there is limited pricing talent in the market; and (5) many incumbent software vendors still need to be aggressive about disrupting themselves and technology focused leadership might be the best way for companies to position for success.

Company Insights (Alphabetical Order)

Adobe

Speakers: Interim CFO and SVP Steve Day, and VP IR Doug Clark

- **Widening the aperture:** Management noted how in the past, Adobe's single- and all-app offerings were asked to do a lot in serving the company's wide range of customers. Adobe's newer freemium offerings help open the aperture and bring in new-to-the-franchise customers. The goal is to make users successful quickly, help them build habits, and come back to Adobe solutions again and again. Adobe recognizes that customers have more choices than ever to create content, and it's up to



them to delight customers, and management believes Adobe's offerings are second to none. They added that many users are performing intent and action-based searches rather than brand-based searches. Adobe created micro-studios where users can perform the action they searched for and be successful quickly. While that may not drive near-term monetization, it delights users, builds usage and creates an opportunity to bring the users back to use more capabilities and eventually monetize them down the road. Understandably, this strategy will take time to play out as the company collects usage telemetry to build a stronger monetization strategy.

- **Customer Experience Orchestration:** Adobe's CXO offerings tend to be more oriented to enterprise, and management believes that the change to an agentic world provides the company with great opportunities. Adobe's Brand Visibility solutions help give brands the best chance to capture as many customers as possible, whether human or agentic. Adobe's content supply chain and AEP offerings combine to create unique hyper-personalization opportunities for brands in a world where standing out from the noise is harder than ever. Additionally, an agentic interface can help make what has been traditionally a strong and more enterprise-oriented offering more approachable for smaller customers, widening the customer pool.

- **Growth algorithm:** Management reiterated that the company's growth algorithm remains driven by new users first, followed by mix/upsell, and then lastly price. Adobe's goal is to first delight customers with features and functionality and continue adding value to their products. Then, when it makes sense, Adobe will adjust price to match the value customers are getting. Management believes there will be opportunities to raise price as long as customers are treated fairly and ensure they're getting more value from the product. In terms of value-add, particularly at the high end of the creative spectrum, management highlighted adding the creative agent and Topaz Labs to its suite of capabilities, with more innovation to come at Adobe MAX next month.

- **Productivity:** Acrobat and other productivity offerings continue to perform well, which management believes reflects the stickiness and usability of the products. They noted that the main driver of growth has been expanding the surfaces where customers can access Adobe productivity solutions, such as through different browsers, which has expanded the top of funnel. Acrobat AI assistant continues to perform well, and Adobe continues to add more functionality such as Spaces and turning text to podcasts.

Autodesk

Speakers: SVP Operations Solutions Stephen Hooper, and VP IR Simon Mays-Smith

- **AI:** Autodesk's approach to AI spans three scopes of work: task automation, workflow automation and systems automation. As customers move along the spectrum, the complexity of models increases, and the work moves from human- to machine-led. More machine-based interactions create new monetization levers for

Autodesk and drives more value through its ecosystem, and the value machines can drive could possibly be more than humans, which Autodesk can possibly capture via consumption-type pricing. Autodesk has access to a unique, physical dataset that is challenging for any potential disruptor to replicate, which creates a moat around its business and AI opportunity. Autodesk built its own inference stack on AWS that provides cost advantages. Customers are likely to take time to adopt AI solutions given the risks involved with the physical world, though Autodesk helps customers by providing a path from where they are today to where they want to get to with AI via its industry clouds. Please see our Autodesk University takeaways note for customer feedback on Autodesk's AI offerings.

- **MaintainX Opportunity/Use cases:** MaintainX has historically had a strong presence within manufacturing, particularly down-market. However, there is little difference within the built environment between a shop floor and managing a building, so there is very little that needs to be done to bring it to A&E customers. One Autodesk customer, a large North American retailer, uses MaintainX to reduce spoilage by evaluating when assets are operating outside normal parameters. This in turn also brought along Tandem for digital twins for all their stores as well as other design products. Another European building design and management firm was using Tandem for digital twins, and then asked to bring on MaintainX to help manage building uptime in the near-term. Another opportunity Mr. Hooper pointed to beyond helping operators is how MaintainX can help OEMs gather data on their products and help refine designs going forward.

- **MaintainX Go To Market:** One of MaintainX's strong points is its mobile-first user experience, which makes it easy to adopt and deploy. This in turn enables a strong product-led growth motion, with a majority of new customers coming via the MaintainX e-store and strong down-market adoption. Additionally within manufacturing, many companies operate their plants in a more decentralized manner, which creates interesting land-and-expand opportunities: MaintainX can be adopted by plant leaders, creating product champions to drive broader adoption within their organizations. This stands in contrast to more centralized buys like a CAD system which is a much bigger rip and replace. From a geography standpoint, Europe remains under-penetrated compared to North America, and Autodesk could possibly lean on channel partners there (vs more direct sales in the US) to drive adoption.

CrowdStrike

Speakers: CFO Burt Podbere and CAO Anurag Saha

- **The world is coming to CRWD:** CRWD was founded with the goal of protecting customers "where the action happens" across endpoints and cloud workloads. As customers look for strategic partners to enable the safe adoption of AI, CRWD is a natural choice given the endpoint and the cloud are where much of the interaction between users, agents, applications, and enterprise data ultimately occurs. Importantly, the company’s 10+ years of labeled security data, combined with visibility across multiple control points, provides the foundation for differentiated



detection and response as AI-enabled threats become faster and more sophisticated. Since the introduction of cyber-capable models earlier this year, the company has seen an “incredible uptick” in customer meetings and record pipeline which together provided mgmt. with the confidence to guide to record NNARR in F3Q.

- **Time for boldness:** With underlying technology advancing at breakneck speed, mgmt. views the current moment as a time to be bold across Product and GTM. Developing differentiated products at speed remains a key priority, perhaps best exemplified by the announcement of SafeMind - a family of cyber-focused models and harnesses built on NVDA’s open-source Nemotron models - at Fal.Con 2026. Mgmt. is also open to M&A of all sizes to accelerate product roadmaps, though any potential target must integrate seamlessly into CRWD’s single-agent architecture. Combining market-leading products in a unified platform, seamlessly delivered through Flex, is resulting in deeper customer commitments; initial Re-Flex transactions drive ~25% average ending ARR uplift and customers completing two or more Re-Flexes expand ARR by 53% versus their original Flex commitment. As a pioneer of this procurement model in security, Flex is a reflection of CRWD's relentless drive to remain at the leading edge of innovation.

- **Sustainable endpoint momentum:** The current threat landscape is driving infrastructure modernization as customers consolidate spending onto fewer platforms and replace legacy endpoint products that are increasingly vulnerable to AI-enabled attacks. This has been a key driver of impressive multi-quarter acceleration in the core EDR business at scale. Management estimates that nearly half of the endpoint market still remains on legacy technology, providing CRWD with a substantial and durable replacement opportunity, particularly in international markets. Falcon Guardian strengthens the modernization case by extending the value of replacing legacy endpoint tools beyond traditional EDR to securing AI agents, providing discovery, runtime visibility, and enforcement where agents execute.

Intuit

Speakers: Chief Financial Officer Sandeep Aujla

- **Recapturing DIY Tax share:** Mr. Aujla feels confident in Intuit's strategy to leverage two distinct brands to address the DIY market, with premium-positioned TurboTax focused on more complex returns and Credit Karma Tax targeting price-sensitive filers with a lower AGI. Given the decades building TurboTax's brand (including more meaningful advertising campaigns the last several years), the team does not want to dilute the TurboTax brand (which is perceived as a premium brand) with a more value-oriented offering that competes with the likes of FreeTaxUSA. Instead, Intuit will lean on in-app discovery and lifecycle marketing within Credit Karma, where a meaningful portion of members do not currently file through an Intuit offering to drive unit growth and win back customers that previously went to other methods. While management expects some trade-down from TurboTax, they noted the majority of customers in its Credit Karma Tax pilot were net new. Rather than maximizing revenue at the point of filing, Intuit will monetize these



customers over time through Credit Karma's broader financial offerings. Customers using both TurboTax and Credit Karma generate roughly 2x the ARPC of single-product users.

- **LLM Tax Competition:** Given headlines around newer AI models being able to handle personal tax forms with improved accuracy, Mr. Aujla fielded several questions regarding this topic. He and the rest of the team believe these AI tax benchmarks (1) can be gamed; (2) highlight that models are not 100% accurate, which is very important to individuals in terms of confidence; and (3) focus too heavily on form completion, which is only a small part of the customer workflow. They believe Intuit's value also comes from gathering and validating financial data, submitting returns, tracking filing status, offering faster access to refunds (1/3 of customers leverage this service), and most importantly providing human accountability. In terms of risk to Assisted Tax, management does not believe they are seeing meaningful evidence of taxpayers leveraging GenAI tools such as Muse to trade down to a DIY product, including this extension season. Customers continue to value having a human review, sign and take accountability for the return, while AI should automate more of the preparation process and provide a meaningful margin benefit. Intuit believes its permissioned financial data, tax expertise and ability to combine LLMs with deterministic tax engines differentiate Intuit Intelligence from general-purpose models.

- **Expanding the QuickBooks funnel:** QuickBooks Free and Lite are designed to capture SMBs earlier in their lifecycle, when many still rely on spreadsheets or point solutions and previously may have not adopted QuickBooks until their second year in business. Payments provides an opportunity to monetize customers from day one, while lifecycle marketing and a common platform should allow Intuit to move customers into higher-value offerings as they grow. Management highlighted Advanced as the primary upgrade destination for customers requiring better reporting and analytics, while Intuit Enterprise Suite is aimed at larger and more complex multi-entity businesses. Management is not seeing competition impact growth and cited stable retention rates.

- **Multiple growth drivers remain in the early innings:** Management was most enthusiastic about Assisted Tax, where local discovery, referrals and greater brand awareness should support new-to-the-franchise growth. Intuit is prudently assuming fewer DIY-to-Live upgrades after these contributed more than 75% of TurboTax Live customer additions over the last two years, with the next phase more dependent on taking share from traditional preparers. Within the business platform, management highlighted momentum in Advanced, Intuit Enterprise Suite and Intuit Accountant Suite. The accountant channel should become an increasingly important source of mid-market referrals, while greater adoption of payments, payroll and other services provides an additional ARPC opportunity. Assisted Tax, money and mid-market collectively represent approximately 30% of Intuit revenue and are growing above 30%.

- **Sequence:** Intuit announced it signed an agreement to acquire Sequence, an AI-native revenue automation company, to extend its



revenue management capabilities, particularly in its mid-market offerings. Sequence's capabilities also will allow Intuit to serve new industries more effectively, particularly B2B software and professional services. When Mr. Aujla was asked about how the company thinks about building, buying and partnering, he noted that for possible acquisitions Intuit has a preference for smaller deals with faster time to market from their products, similar to the GoCo acquisition the company made previously. The Sequence acquisition seems to fit this framework well.

Netskope

Speakers: CEO Sanjay Beri, CFO Drew Del Matto, and Chief Communications & Investor Relations Officer Michelle Spolver

- **Architecture for the Cloud & AI eras:** NTSK was founded around the view that enterprises would need more granular control over cloud applications, rather than simply allowing or blocking web access. Mgmt. believes this architecture translates naturally to AI, where interactions similarly rely on APIs and JSON, enabling its core inspection engine to understand transactions and apply data protection controls already used by >90% of customers. Importantly, this application awareness is supported by a purpose-built network and software designed for high-speed, in-memory processing at the edge. As agents communicate more frequently and enterprises become increasingly sensitive to latency, mgmt. sees network performance and real-time policy enforcement becoming more strategically important. Ownership of the underlying infrastructure also supports sovereign processing requirements. Together, these capabilities position NTSK to participate in both AI-driven network modernization through SASE and incremental demand for its distinct AI security offerings.

- **Building a horizontal AI security platform:** Mgmt. characterized customers' initial AI security priority as removing the "blindfold" around enterprise usage, including discovering agents, LLMs, and MCP servers, before establishing controls over their activity. NTSK aims to address this progression through a horizontal AI security platform that combines visibility with real-time policy enforcement across models and applications. Its network inspection capabilities are complemented by endpoint functionality that captures local AI activity and an AI Gateway deployable as a container or VM in private environments. This breadth is important given that AI activity often does not exclusively traverse the cloud network, while widespread use of personal instances of corporate-sanctioned applications creates data protection risks that application-level approval alone cannot address. AI Command Center brings these capabilities together, with the opportunity to provide consistent governance as customers adopt different models and deployment environments.

- **GTM investment progressing as expected:** Mgmt.'s planned GTM investments are progressing as planned, with reps in EMEA expected to ramp first, followed by those in APAC then NA. The maturing GTM organization likely coincides with an even more constructive cyber demand environment as more customers explicitly budget for AI and related security investments for 2027. In this vein, mgmt. expects recent

heightened interest in network and network security modernization projects following the release of cyber-capable models earlier this year to translate into more meaningful new business in F4Q and FY28.

Okta

Speakers: President & COO Eric Kelleher and SVP Investor Relations Dave Gennarelli

- **Focused on Driving Okta for AI Agents Adoption:** The company is currently focused on driving broad adoption of Okta for AI Agents as customers continue to evaluate their broader agentic identity needs. Mgmt. is implementing a number of measures to minimize the friction to adopt the product suite, most notably through user-based pricing (i.e., more predictable vs agent/transaction-based pricing) and providing Agent SSO to all current user-access management customers at no extra cost. As disclosed at the recent investor session at Oktane 2026, early O4AA deals have yielded a ~30-50% uplift in ACV. That said, given the nascency of the product, the company believes it is still too early to extrapolate these trends across their broader base of 20k+ customers, and are therefore not internally projecting expected uplift from these deals. To be clear, while OKTA has set internal O4AA bookings targets for this year, there is very little contribution from the product suite embedded in FY27 guidance.
- **Leveraging broader tech ecosystem to position themselves as strategic enabler of AI adoption:** Mgmt. emphasized that securing the agentic enterprise will require collaboration across the technology ecosystem rather than any one vendor controlling every layer. Okta is seeking to catalyze this ecosystem through Cross App Access, where adoption continues to broaden. At a broader architectural level, the Blueprint Alliance brings together technology vendors to define how agentic security products should interoperate. While direct economic benefits remain nascent, these initiatives likely strengthen Okta's position as the neutral identity layer connecting agents, applications, and security controls, while creating a natural on-ramp into the broader O4AA platform.
- **Okta for AI Agents as a distinct land product:** With support for 3P identity providers, Okta for AI Agents (O4AA) can serve as a distinct land product even where Okta does not provide the incumbent workforce identity platform. This enables customers to adopt O4AA to discover, secure, and govern agents without first replacing their existing IdP. Over time, these initial agentic identity deployments could broaden into larger platform modernization discussions as customers reassess whether legacy identity architectures are equipped for an agentic world. This creates a potentially compelling land-and-expand opportunity for Okta to pull through its core workforce platform alongside governance, privileged access, and customer identity. However, this opportunity remains nascent, with the vast majority of early O4AA adopters already Okta IdP customers.
- **Measured approach to adding GTM capacity:** With sales productivity and rep tenure improving, mgmt. believes the current GTM structure is



performing well following several rounds of specialization over the past 18 months. While the company intends to add capacity behind areas of strong demand, including O4AA, it is taking a measured approach and prioritizing productivity from the existing organization before accelerating hiring more broadly. The company is also deepening channel relationships, especially with large integrators, to drive further leverage as they transition the services business to the channel.

Palo Alto Networks

Speakers: EVP Network Security Anand Oswal and SVP IR and Strategic Finance Hamza Fodderwala

- **Built for this moment:** Mgmt. has characterized the current moment as the greatest opportunity in cybersecurity to date, with recent conversations with several CIOs suggesting 2027 security budgets could grow closer to double-digits versus the typical low-to-mid-single-digit. While demand since the introduction of cyber-capable models earlier this year will take time to materialize given nine-to-12-month sales cycles, PANW appears well positioned through its control points across endpoint, network, cloud, and identity. With threat actors increasingly moving at machine speed, tighter integration across these sensors enables customers to close gaps between siloed tools, improve threat detection, and automate response, reducing mean time to detect and remediate. PANW is also becoming increasingly levered to AI activity and token flow, for example with SASE (mix of per-user and throughput-based pricing), AI Gateway, Chronosphere, and Frontier AI Defense.
- **Importance of the network as a control point in the AI era:** AI adoption is increasing network activity, with agentic traffic across PANW's SASE platform rising 9x over the last nine months as autonomous agents interact continuously with models, tools, skills, MCP servers, and enterprise data. This expands the enterprise attack surface and thus increases the importance of inline controls that can inspect traffic and enforce policy in real time. PANW is well positioned through its hardware and software firewalls and SASE fabric, which provide distributed enforcement points across on-premise, cloud, and remote-user environments, complemented by Koi at the endpoint and their AI Gateway (i.e., Portkey acquisition) for AI traffic. Importantly, this breadth allows PANW to correlate activity, enforce consistent policies, and automate patching across control points as traffic moves across the enterprise.
- **In the midst of a hardware cycle:** The heightened AI threat environment is driving strong appliance demand as customers accelerate efforts to modernize aging infrastructure, i.e., 7+ year-old firewalls, and purchase net new appliances to protect a growing attack surface. Pricing is providing an additional growth tailwind following a 10% list-price increase in April and a further increase in October, while post-quantum cryptography could provide an incremental refresh catalyst given 30-40% of the installed base is Gen 3 or earlier and lacks PAN-OS quantum capabilities. New deployment opportunities are also emerging in AI data centers, particularly among neoclouds that lack hyperscalers' internally developed firewalling capabilities, and in OT environments through



ruggedized appliances (and PANW now has a dedicated sales team). That said, with ~1 million appliances in the field, 14 attached subscriptions, and 20-30c realized per $1 of hardware for each subscription, PANW's focus is on cross-selling attached subscriptions and services to their ~60k NGFW customers.

Rubrik

Speakers: CFO Kiran Choudary and Co-Founder & CTO Arvind Nithrakashyap

- **AI strengthens the strategic importance of cyber resilience:** AI is increasing the strategic importance of next-gen cyber resilience platforms as enterprises modernize their data infrastructure and confront new risks from non-deterministic software and autonomous agents. To this point, mgmt. categorized cyber resilience as a "top-three" customer security priority, with concerns increasingly extending beyond traditional cyberattacks to agents misappropriating, corrupting, or destroying sensitive data. RBRK is addressing this opportunity through three complementary pillars: data resilience, identity resilience, and agent control. Importantly, these capabilities reinforce and build upon one another, as RBRK's understanding of enterprise applications and the sensitivity of underlying data can be combined with the identities and permissions agents use to provide more granular runtime guardrails and reverse unwanted changes. This creates an opportunity for RBRK to extend existing customer relationships from core data protection into identity resilience and, over time, agent governance, while AI-driven infrastructure modernization could broaden the population of customers prioritizing modern resilience platforms. That said, RBRK has not yet seen a meaningful pipeline inflection following the release of more cyber-capable frontier models earlier this year, while broader agent-driven data creation remains limited as enterprise deployments and use cases are still relatively nascent.
- **RAC differentiated by application context and agent rewind:** Rubrik Agent Cloud (RAC) brings together agent discovery and observability, identity context, runtime guardrails, and the ability to reverse agents' actions. Amidst an increasingly crowded market where several vendors offer agent observability and identity controls, RBRK's multi-pillar approach provides a differentiated understanding of enterprise applications, the sensitivity of underlying data, and the identities agents use to access it. Combined with RBRK's Semantic AI Governance Engine (SAGE), which interprets agent intent to enforce policies in real time, this context enables more granular runtime governance than many competing approaches. Agent Rewind provides further differentiation by moving beyond identifying an unwanted action to reversing its effects across applications and data. That said, RAC remains in the early stages of implementation, and RBRK is prioritizing validation of product-market fit over prematurely scaling customer adoption
- **Limited impact from rising hardware prices:** Mgmt. has not seen an impact from rising hardware prices or extended lead times on Subscription NNARR to date. Data resilience is a key investment priority, and enterprise data protection (on-prem / self-managed) now only accounts for ~20% of Subscription NNARR. In some cases, customers can



adopt backup-as-a-service, though we question the fungibility of deployment models given that regulatory, sovereignty, and performance requirements may necessitate self-hosted infrastructure.

Salesforce

Speakers: VP Product Management Shannon Matthews, EVP Global IR Mark Murphy, and Senior Manager IR Sam Schmidt

- **SIforce partnerships:** Partnerships including Claudeforce bring Salesforce's data and workflows into customers' preferred interfaces through jointly developed MCP connectors and prebuilt Skills, while retaining underlying Salesforce license requirements. Customers get easy-to-use workflows including meeting preparation, account-health checks and dashboard analysis, backed by Salesforce's security and governance, without having to build and maintain those capabilities themselves. Ongoing co-development optimizes performance and latency, with management expecting lower token consumption than DIY integrations. Early beta customers are using underlying Salesforce capabilities 5-6x more, with November GA targeted and additional use cases planned.
- **License revenue dynamics:** Improving recurring-revenue business momentum remains offset by significant on-premise license pressures. Slack, AI, Data and Agentforce are performing well, while Marketing Cloud Next is showing early net-new AOV improvement. On the other hand, Commerce remains challenged without clear evidence of a turnaround. Across Tableau, MuleSoft and Informatica, cloud migrations, contract-duration dynamics and competitive pressure are weighing on upfront revenue, with management characterizing the issue as more about duration and deployment mix than simply renewal rates. Easier comparisons should help, but management is not assuming a sharp recovery.
- **Growth versus margins:** Management remains focused on returning to double-digit growth, emphasizing product development and go-to-market investment alongside continued internal efficiencies, rather than another period of rapid margin expansion. We expect SIforce partnerships can potentially be gross-margin accretive, as customers contract separately with AI labs for tokens, leaving inference revenue and costs with the model provider while Salesforce benefits from moving customers onto higher-priced SKUs and monetizing its underlying workflows. This offers a potentially attractive way to participate in greater AI-driven usage without absorbing the associated token-cost burden, although pricing uplift benefits will take time to materialize.
- **Internal transformation:** Salesforce's internal transformation extends beyond the AI product roadmap, with every function expected to adopt AI tools, and product teams pushed toward faster release cycles and stronger customer-adoption accountability. Management sees further efficiency opportunities, but characterizes this as a multiyear organizational shift rather than a near-term cost-cutting exercise.



Snowflake

We had the pleasure of hosting EVP Product Christian Kleinerman, CFO Brian Robins, and Head of Investor Relations Katherine McCracken

- **CoCo Accelerates Time to Value:** CoWork Expands the Opportunity. Management framed adoption across two dimensions: the number of customer accounts using the products and the depth of users within each account. CoCo has made strong progress on the first, with more than 9,100 accounts now using the product, but penetration remains limited to a relatively small number of Snowflake users within those organizations. This leaves a meaningful opportunity to expand adoption among Snowflake's traditional technical personas, including data engineers, data scientists and business analysts. CoCo is also beginning to compress time to value by helping customers write code, build pipelines and complete migrations faster; tasks that would have been difficult to automate even a year ago are now increasingly handled through AI-assisted development. CoWork potentially expands the opportunity further by extending Snowflake beyond technical users to virtually any employee, with BI and conversational access to enterprise data emerging as the initial use case. Management acknowledged this represents a newer and more challenging go-to-market motion, but believes CoWork can ultimately support broader workflows and applications without requiring users to operate directly in BI, CRM or other systems. While current consumption remains small relative to the potential opportunity, management indicated that existing adoption is contributing revenue and that increasing users per account represents the larger monetization lever. Snowflake reported 5,800 CoWork accounts in F2Q27.

- **Migrations Remain a Driving Force:** Large enterprise migrations remain a core source of growth, with management emphasizing that Snowflake has addressed only a small portion of the data still residing in legacy environments such as Cloudera, Oracle and Teradata. Some large enterprises continue to operate hundreds of petabytes outside Snowflake. Mgmt. cited the considerable gap in annual spending between Snowflake's largest 25 customers at an average of $34m/year and the average Global 2000 customer at $2.4m/year as an indicator of the expansion opportunity remaining, while also flagging the older customer cohorts (even 6-7 years+) remain among the fastest growing. The data transfer itself is generally the easiest part of a migration; converting the surrounding code, pipelines, applications and business processes remains the primary bottleneck. Management believes AI coding tools are beginning to materially reduce this friction and accelerate migration timelines in ways that were not feasible even a year ago. The latest quarter's 126% net revenue retention rate and 89% year-over-year increase in deployed production use cases provide additional evidence that new migrations are translating into broader consumption.

- **The Competitive Environment Continues to Evolve:** Snowflake's competitive positioning is increasingly centered on providing a neutral, governed data and AI layer across models, applications and clouds. Management sees credibility in being model independent and helping



customers select the appropriate model for each task, particularly as smaller, specialized open models improve and inference pricing declines. The same argument applies at the application layer: while application vendors position their proprietary data and business context as the enterprise center of gravity, management believes most large customers operate across multiple systems and remain reluctant to copy all their data into any one application ecosystem. Snowflake's response is to combine broad cross-cloud data access with metadata connectors, MCP support, OpenFlow and Apache Iceberg interoperability, allowing agents to use context distributed across a customer's estate. CoWork also introduces a broader competitive set across BI, productivity software and enterprise applications. Management cited replacement of traditional BI interfaces as an early use case, but expects displacement of smaller applications and workflows to occur over time as well; replacement of deeply embedded systems such as SAP are seen as highly unlike any time soon. Data gravity and governance was expressed as being more durable than any individual model or semantic layer, reinforcing Snowflake's strategy of making the underlying data, rather than a proprietary application or model, the anchor for enterprise AI.

Vercel (Private)

Speakers: CEO Guillermo Rauch, CFO Marten Abrahamsen and VP Finance Peter Daley

- **What Vercel does:** Vercel aims to be the application and agentic operating platform of choice by abstracting away infrastructure configuration so developers and agents can move from code to a production application with minimal friction. Its core offerings span deployment and preview environments, global content delivery, serverless execution through Fluid Compute, observability, and application security, alongside developer tools such as Next.js and v0. Increasingly, Vercel is extending that platform into an integrated "Agent Stack": AI SDK provides a consistent interface across model providers; AI Gateway supplies model routing, monitoring, budgets, and failover; Workflows support durable, multi-step execution; Sandbox provides isolated environments for running untrusted code; and Connect supplies secure access to external systems.
- **Why Vercel is well positioned for the agentic era:** Management's thesis is that the developer experience that made Vercel attractive to humans also makes it attractive to coding agents: its CLI, APIs, MCP integration, automatic preview URLs, and rollbacks enable agents to build, test, and deploy without navigating manual infrastructure setup. Vercel reports coding agents initiated more than 50% of deployments on the platform as of September 2026, and agent-deployed projects were 20 times more likely to call AI inference providers than human-deployed projects. Its second advantage is serving the resulting workloads, which require model access, durable orchestration, isolated execution, and observability rather than just short-lived web requests. Management sees its existing developer relationships and integrated product portfolio as a distribution advantage, with model-provider choice allowing customers to change models with minimal code change. Management



believes they are well positioned to grow from (1) meaningful market expansion and (2) share gain from other market participants such as Cloudflare.

- **Rationale and opportunity for expanding into security:** Management frames security as a natural extension of owning the application runtime: as agents execute generated code and access enterprise systems, customers need protection not only against inbound attacks but also against credential exposure, unauthorized access, and data exfiltration. Vercel already offers automatic DDoS mitigation, web application firewall, bot management, and workspace security. Its agent-oriented controls extend that foundation through Sandbox network restrictions and credential injection that keeps secrets outside the execution environment, Connect's short-lived and scoped credentials, and Passport's integration with customers' identity providers. The commercial opportunity is to attach these protections to workloads Vercel already hosts and expand from more narrow developer and agentic adoption of individual use cases into broader platform purchases.

Zscaler

Speakers: SVP Product Management Steve House and SVP IR and Strategic Finance Kim Watkins

- **Multiple paths to $8bn ARR by FY31:** While catalyzing the development of a novel security segment (i.e., AI security), enterprise AI adoption is also likely to be a demand tailwind for the broader sector as customers reevaluate and modernize their security stack. To this point, mgmt. is positive on new business momentum across the platform and sees multiple routes to achieving the $8bn ARR target outlaid at the recent investor day. The growth algorithm is based on continued install base cross-sell, where mgmt. is targeting >$15bn of whitespace (~5x expansion opportunity), and improved new logo growth (and is a key tenet of new CRO Ross Tackett's GTM strategy). In the case of more significant AI tailwinds, i.e., faster/greater adoption of AI tools, agents etc., mgmt. sees an aspirational though achievable path to reaching $10bn ARR by FY31. Importantly, the company's monetization model is becoming increasingly diversified, with customer agreements combining seat-based pricing with branch- and traffic-based components.

- **Compelling right to win in AI security:** AI security is expected to be a key driver of incremental growth over the next five years, and mgmt. has assumed that customers spend ~2% of their total AI budget on these tools. Against estimates from other cyber peers that put this at closer to 3-5%, mgmt.'s assumptions appear prudent. In an increasingly noisy competitive AI security landscape, the company confidently outlined their right to win given the vast amount of telemetry that flows through the platform as they sit in the flow of traffic, processing ~750bn transactions per day with further context from their clients installed on 60m endpoints. Importantly, ZS also has the ability to secure east-west traffic from agents (as well as other entities) through gateways that remove the need for traffic to egress to a POP for inspection and policy enforcement.



- **Multiple drivers support sustained double-digit SASE for Users growth:** Mgmt. is confident that SASE for Users can sustain double digit growth over the next 5 years. The company sees a number of exciting growth opportunities, including: (1) ZPA cross-sell, with 30% of the install base yet to purchase the product; (2) ZPA upsell to higher tiers within current install base; (3) New logo growth, especially with ZPA as customers remove applications from the internet to minimize lateral movement and blast radius; (4) ZT Browser, which is the fastest growing product within the broader suite; (5) Down-market share gains, where ZS has partnered with Carahsoft and has introduced simplified bundles to encourage adoption from more resource-constrained customers.

Appendix 1

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w/ Banking relationship	43%	34%	0%
w/ MiFID services	63%	52%	67%

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